

NSW RUGBY UNION

# New South Wales Rugby Union

**NSW RUGBY IS COMMITTED TO BUILDING A THRIVING UNITED RUGBY ECOSYSTEM - FROM THE LOCAL CLUB TO THE INTERNATIONAL STAGE**

# NSW RUGBY UNION THROUGH THE YEARS

Following the British & Irish Lions Tour in 2025, Australia will host a landmark decade of global rugby, with the Men's Rugby World Cup in 2027 followed by the Women's Rugby World Cup in 2029.

**1847**
NSW Rugby Established

**1882**
First NSW District Team



**1900**
Sydney Competition began



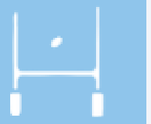
**1927/8**
Waratahs Tour to UK



**1963**
Waratahs Shield - Schools



**1994**
First NSW Mens & Womens Team



**1995**
Professional Rugby Began



**2003**
RWC in Australia



**2014**
Waratahs Super Rugby Championship



**2017**
Positive Rugby Foundation



**2018-25**
Waratahs Super W Championships Began



**2022**
Rugby For Good Launched



# NSW RUGBY UNION AT SCALE



**56%**

**OF AUSTRALIA'S RUGBY PARTICIPANTS**

**100,000+**

**REGISTERED PLAYERS ACROSS JUNIOR & SENIOR PROGRAMS**

**3.2M**

**PEOPLE REACHED ACROSS NSW**

*The largest and most influential rugby member union in the country.*

# ABOUT OUR POSITIVE RUGBY FOUNDATION

Rugby For Good is the social impact and community program of the NSW Positive Rugby Foundation, using rugby as a platform to drive positive change across communities in New South Wales. The program focuses on improving health, wellbeing, inclusion, and participation by leveraging the unique values and life skills associated with rugby.



## GIRLS & WOMEN'S RUGBY

Drives increased female participation by creating inclusive, accessible pathways for girls and women to engage in rugby at all levels.



## SCHOOL & JUNIOR RUGBY

Introduces young people to rugby through school and grassroots programs that build skills, confidence, and lifelong participation.



## MENTAL HEALTH

Uses rugby environments to encourage open conversations and raise awareness around mental health and wellbeing.



## COUNTRY & REGIONAL RUGBY

Supports the growth and sustainability of rugby in regional communities by improving access to programs, resources, and development opportunities beyond metropolitan areas.



## WESTERN SYDNEY DEVELOPMENT

Expands rugby participation and access in growth areas by delivering targeted programs that support diverse and underserved communities.

# STRATEGIC PILLARS OF NSW RUGBY UNION

How we grow, protect and lead the game statewide.

## GREAT COMPETITIONS

Globally leading player, supporter and volunteer experiences that create excitement and inspire passion

- Club Development
- Competitions/Tournaments
- Match Officials & Integrity
- Player & Development Pathways

## GROWTH & ENGAGEMENT

Targeted recruitment and retention programs that engage and connect people to clubs and schools

- Participation growth & retention
- Women & girls rugby
- Western Sydney & regional NSW
- Coaches, workforce & facilities
- Rugby For Good initiatives

## SUSTAINABLE FUTURE

Ensure the Financial Prosperity while creating a positive social impact and being a leader in Sport in Australia

- Commercial partnerships & sponsorships
- Government, grants & funding
- Donors & philanthropy
- Media, content & NSW Rugby TV
- Promoting the game statewide

*Together, these pillars ensure NSW Rugby Union remains the backbone of Australian Rugby.*

# NSW RUGBY UNION ECOSYSTEM

Connecting community, pathways and performance across the state.

## COMMUNITY & PARTICIPATION

### NSW Juniors

- Schools
- Country
- Sydney

### NSW Womens
(coming 2026)

### Referees & Partners

### Suburban & Country Rugby

- Mens
- Womens

## NSW Rugby Union

*Stewardship of the game statewide.*

### Sydney Rugby Union

- Shute Shield
- Colts
- Jack Scott Cup

### Country Rugby Union

- Mens
- Womens

## PERFORMANCE & ELITE

### NSW Waratahs

- Mens
- Womens

### Rugby Australia

- Wallabies
- Wallaroos
- Aussie 7s

## IMPACT, SUPPORT & INVESTMENT

### Positive Rugby Foundation

- Illawara Hub
- Dubbo Hub
- Northern Hub
- Newcastle Hub
- Corporate Coteries
- Corterie Members
- Donors

# POSITIVE RUGBY FOUNDATION

Using rugby as a force for positive change across NSW.

## PRF invested $1M

into Rugby for Good Programs in 2025.

Rugby is more than a game — it brings people together and creates positive change. Through the NSW Positive Rugby Foundation, we harness the power of rugby to support healthier, more connected communities across NSW.



### HEALTH & WELLBEING

Rugby as a vehicle for physical and mental well-being.



### ACCESS & INCLUSION

Improving access to quality of grassroots programs.



### COMMUNITY CONNECTION

Creating opportunity, belonging and life skills through rugby.

# NSW RUGBY WORLD CUP LEGACY PROGRAM

$10 million from the NSW Government to provide a legacy for the 2027 Men's Rugby World Cup in NSW.

## NSW RUGBY UNION LEGACY PLAN

$5 million - To build participation by removing barriers through 5 pillars:

- Facilities & Equipment
- Priority Regions & Pathways
- Programs & Workforce
- Inclusion
- RWC Activation

## CLUB LEGACY GRANTS

Round 1 - $2.15M under delivery
Round 2 - $2.15M yet to be announced

- Category 1 - Infrastucture $25k to $150K
- Category 2 - Participation $5K to $50K

Delivery by local clubs, Zones and Associations.

## CLUB EQUIPMENT GRANTS

$350K split evenly across all NSW Ruby Clubs.

- Approx $1,500 worth of equipment to every Rugby Club in NSW
- To commence in coming weeks, delivery in February 2026

# WHY WE NEED THIS PROJECT?

NSW Rugby currently has no performance measurement frameworks or tools.

# WHY DOES THIS MATTER?

NSW Rugby cannot measure the outcomes of the work we do through Rugby for Good and now the Rugby World Cup Legacy Program.

This impacts the ability to apply for more grant funding and to attract private investment.

Also impacts our storytelling and narrative without tangible outcomes.

## MEASUREMENTS



### ECONOMIC IMPACTS

Changes that strengthen the economic sustainability of the sport and active recreation sector, improve workforce capability, and contribute to NSW's broader economic prosperity.



### CULTRAL OUTCOMES

Changes that strengthen cultural identity, inclusion, safety and belonging within sport environments, particularly for priority populations.



### SOCIAL IMPACTS

xChanges that improve community wellbeing, social connection, safety, resilience and participation in sport and active recreation.

# PROJECT DELIVERABLES



## BEST PRACTICE IMPACT FRAMEWORKS

Research of best practice impact frameworks amongst other sporting codes internationally and domestically. Whilst ensuring the framework is compliant with NSW Treasury Guidelines.



## METRICS, METHODS AND DATA SOURCES

Identify what metrics are best to use to measure the outcomes and benefits, what data sources are available (including benefit banks) and how to analyse the data and monetise the benefits.



## BASELINE ASSESSMENT

Using existing data and past anaylsis, set a baseline of outcomes that can then be used as a comparision post Legacy Funding.



## TRACKING TOOLS

A set of recommended ongoing tracking tools (surveys, attendance capturing, post-event follow-up scripts)



## DASHBOARD CALUCULATOR

Creation of a dashboard or calculator prototype for data collection and visibility (to support later Phases i.e. national/Rubgy4Good scalability)

# MULTI STAGE PROJECT

UNSW Employability - Interdisciplinary Partnership with NSW Rugby Union

| CURRENT STAGE | SUMMER INTAKE<br>PHASE 2 | TERM ONE<br>PHASE 3 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| To build a Impact Measurement Framework using the NSW Rugby World Cup Legacy Program as the piolt.<br><br>Teams addressing the pillars:<br><br>• Facilities & Equipment<br>• Priority Regions & Pathways<br>• Programs & Workforce<br>• Inclusion<br>• RWC Activation | Refinement/Selection of Impact Measurement Framework, tracking tools & dashboard/calculator.<br><br>Testing of the chosen framework or tools against existing delivered Legacy Pillars.<br><br>Community engagement, surveying, interviews for case studies. | National scalability for ‘Rugby for Good’ Programs and other Rugby programs.<br><br>Build capacity within NSW Rugby Union to measure outcomes of any future programs and improve the story telling. |



NSW RUGBY UNION

# Contacts


**PROJECT LEAD**
**DONA D'AMICO**
**0411791813**
**DONA.DAMICO@NSW.RUGBY**

**ONSITE BACK UP**
**MARK GREEN**
**0407 414 779**
**MARK GREEN@NSW.RUGBY**